Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q 9 8 6 4 ♥ A J 2 ♦ 8 ♣ 6 5 4	
♠ A 2 ♥ Q 9 8 3 ♦ 7 6 5 3 ♣ 10 9 7	N W E S	♠ 7 ♥ 10 7 5 4 ♦ A 9 4 2 ♣ K Q J 3
	♠ J 10 5 3 ♥ K 6 ♦ K Q J 10 ♣ A 8 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	1♠	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♣K

North is to play 4♠. East leads the ♣K.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 4

The ♣ lead was terrible for you as it exposes your 2 ♣ losers before you can establish a ♦ for a discard. If you start to pull trumps now the defense will grab their ♠A, their 2 ♣s and their ♦A.

If you try to establish a ♦ they will do the same thing, just in a different order. What does that leave you?

You win the ♣A in dummy.

Everyone follows low.

West plays low.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 4

The ♣ lead was terrible for you as it exposes your 2 ♣ losers before you can establish a ♦ for a discard. If you start to pull trumps now the defense will grab their ♠A, their 2 ♣s and their ♦A.

If you try to establish a ♦ they will do the same thing, just in a different order. What does that leave you?

It leaves you trying the only possible way you can make this contract, finessing West for the ♥Q to get a ♣ discard from dummy.

You win the ♣A in dummy, play the ♥K, thenreturn a ♥ to your ♥J. You then discard a ♣ from dummy on the ♥A.

When you have only one chance to make your contract you take it.

This time it worked, another time it might not.

Board 2
North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K 8 6 4 2
♥ —
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ Q J 10 2

♠ Q J 10 9
♥ Q J 8
♦ 6 5 2
♣ 8 4 3

♠ —
♥ A K 9 6 5 4 2
♦ A Q 4
♣ K 7 5

♠ A 7 5 3
♥ 10 7 3
♦ K 9 8
♣ A 9 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	Pass	1♥	Pass
2♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♥3

East is to play 4♥. South leads the ♥3.

North discards a ♠ and you play the ♥2.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 5

If North has the ♦K, one ♦ loser can be eliminated by a finesse. And, if North also has the ♣A one more loser can be eliminated by leading toward your ♣K. The chance of both cards being held by North isn't very good, only about 25%. But dummy has some nice ♠s. Can you use them?

North plays low.

Yes, you can establish 2 ♠ winners for discards, and most importantly, you can do it without letting North into the lead. This is important because if North gets in and plays a ♣ through your ♣ K 7 5 it might be a disaster.

So win the ♥J in dummy. Uh-Oh, North discards a ♠. Now play the ♠Q and when North plays low, discard a ♣. This is a loser on loser play and South takes the trick with the ♠A.

South now leads the ♥7. You cover with dummy's ♥8 knowing the finesse will win. Next you play dummy's ♠J, covered by North and ruffed by you (if North didn't cover you would throw another ♣ loser). Now enter dummy with the ♥Q, pulling South's last trump at the same time. Discard your 2 ♣s on the ♠ 10 9 and try the ♦ finesse for an overtrick.

This loser-on-loser play didn't have much to do with trump management.

Just the fact that you had to use the trump suit for entries to dummy, and therefore couldn't immediately pull trumps.

Board 3
East Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 6 ♥ 8 5 4 2 ♦ K 8 7 2 ♣ 9 5 4	
♠ 8 3 ♥ K Q J 7 ♦ 10 6 4 ♣ A J 10 7	N W E S	♠ 10 5 2 ♥ 10 9 3 ♦ J 9 5 3 ♣ K Q 8
	♠ A Q J 9 7 4 ♥ A 6 ♦ A Q ♣ 6 3 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	1♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♥K

South is to play 4♠. West leads the ♥K, dummy plays the ♥2 and East the ♥3.

You win the ♥A and cash the ♠A.

West plays low.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=3 Total = 4

This is a very easy problem to be up here at number 18! Clearly you have to discard one of those 4 losers on the only card dummy has, the ♦K.

Just as clearly you have to be able to enter dummy after you unblock the ♦ A Q so you can't pull trumps immediately.

So here's the Plan. Win the ♥A. Pull one round of trumps with the ♠A. Play the ♦ A Q to get them out of the way. Enter dummy with the ♠K. Play the ♦K, discard a loser, and hope nobody ruffs.

Just remember to always pull trumps immediately . . .

. . . except when you have a good reason not to, like here.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ Q J 10 7 3 ♥ J 3 ♦ 8 6 2 ♣ J 9 5	
♠ K 6 5 4 2 ♥ A K 8 7 4 ♦ A ♣ K 3	N W E S	♠ — ♥ 10 9 6 ♦ K Q J 10 3 ♣ A 8 7 4 2
	♠ A 9 8 ♥ Q 5 2 ♦ 9 7 5 4 ♣ Q 10 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♠	Pass	2♦	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

6♥ by West
Lead: ♠Q

East's 6♥ response to Blackwood showed one Ace and a ♠ void. West is to play 6♥. North leads the ♠Q.

South plays the ♠8 and you the ♠2.

Losers: ♠ = ?? ♥ = 1 ♦ = 0 ♣ = 0 Total = 1 ??

Of course you ruff the ♠ in dummy. North wouldn't underlead an Ace at a slam contract, and since you have a certain trump loser you cannot afford to lose a trick to South's ♠A.

Dummy has some great ♦s, but you can't expect to run them unless you have pulled all the trumps. But if you play ♥ A K 4 the defenders will take their trump trick and immediately set the contract with the ♠A. There **IS** a way around the problem.

South plays low.

North wins with the ♥J.

First off, you must get a 3-2 split in trumps because if they don't split 3-2 you will have two trump losers. So you assume that they are split just like you need them to be.

At trick two you duck a trump. That's right, you lose a trump trick early. Since you have to lose a trump sometime, you do it at a time when the defenders can't hurt you. So a defender wins the trump trick, but now a ♠ play won't hurt because dummy still has a trump to ruff with! In fact, whatever they play next you will win, pull the outstanding trumps, then run dummy's ♦ suit.

This is a very rare play, but a good one to remember.

When you have a trump loser but still need to pull their trumps, it may be better for you to lose an early trump trick rather than a later one.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 7 4 2 ♥ Q J 10 7 ♦ 5 ♣ A 8 6 4 2	
♠ 6 5 ♥ 5 4 3 2 ♦ Q 2 ♣ K Q 9 7 3	N W E S	♠ J 10 9 8 3 ♥ 6 ♦ K J 9 7 4 ♣ J 10
	♠ A K Q ♥ A K 9 8 ♦ A 10 8 6 3 ♣ 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by North
Lead: ♠J

Agreed that the bidding wasn't much. The final contract is still a good one. North is to play 6♥. East leads the ♠J.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=0 ♣=4 Total = 4

There really aren't 4 ♣ losers since they can be ruffed in dummy. In fact you should see that this is an ideal cross-ruff hand, ruffing ♣s in dummy and ♦s in your hand. Since neither hand can be over-ruffed you expect to make all 8 trumps.

Remember, when playing a cross ruff, you need to take any side suit winners first, otherwise a defender may be able to discard that suit while you are ruffing. So you win the ♠A, then take the ♠K, then . . . what?

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=0 ♣=4 Total = 4

There really aren't 4 ♣ losers since they can be ruffed in dummy. In fact you should see that this is an ideal cross-ruff hand, ruffing ♣s in dummy and ♦s in your hand. Since neither hand can be over-ruffed you expect to make all 8 trumps.

Remember, when playing a cross ruff, you need to take any side suit winners first, otherwise a defender may be able to discard that suit while you are ruffing. So you win the ♠A, then take the ♠K, then . . . what?

Well, if you win the ♠Q, then the two Minor suit Aces, you'd be set up to cross-ruff the hand out for all 13 tricks. But here's what might happen if you try.

West might ruff the ♠Q. OK, no disaster yet. But he might then play a trump. Your slam is now kaput. You can no longer make 8 trump tricks and will end up down 1.

The answer is to not be greedy for that overtrick. With East's opening ♠ lead there is an indication of possible length there. So, realizing that West could be short in the suit, take just the 2 ♠ tricks that you need for the slam, then play your Minor Aces and start the cross-ruff.

When playing a cross-ruff you must take all the side-suit winners you need early so they won't get ruffed later.

Don't jeopardize your contract trying to take too many.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ K Q 9 8 6 4
♥ A J 2
♦ 8
♣ 6 5 4

♠ A 2
♥ Q 9 8 3
♦ 7 6 5 3
♣ 10 9 7

♠ 7
♥ 10 7 5 4
♦ A 9 4 2
♣ K Q J 3

♠ J 10 5 3
♥ K 6
♦ K Q J 10
♣ A 8 2

Board 7
South Deals
Both Vul

♠ K 8 6 4 2
♥ —
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ Q J 10 2

♠ Q J 10 9
♥ Q J 8
♦ 6 5 2
♣ 8 4 3

♠ —
♥ A K 9 6 5 4 2
♦ A Q 4
♣ K 7 5

♠ A 7 5 3
♥ 10 7 3
♦ K 9 8
♣ A 9 6

Board 8
West Deals
None Vul

♠ K 6
♥ 8 5 4 2
♦ K 8 7 2
♣ 9 5 4

♠ 8 3
♥ K Q J 7
♦ 10 6 4
♣ A J 10 7

♠ 10 5 2
♥ 10 9 3
♦ J 9 5 3
♣ K Q 8

♠ A Q J 9 7 4
♥ A 6
♦ A Q
♣ 6 3 2

Board 9
North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q J 10 7 3
♥ J 3
♦ 8 6 2
♣ J 9 5

♠ K 6 5 4 2
♥ A K 8 7 4
♦ A
♣ K 3

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6
♦ K Q J 10 3
♣ A 8 7 4 2

♠ A 9 8
♥ Q 5 2
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ Q 10 6

Board 10
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ 7 4 2
♥ Q J 10 7
♦ 5
♣ A 8 6 4 2

♠ 6 5
♥ 5 4 3 2
♦ Q 2
♣ K Q 9 7 3

♠ J 10 9 8 3
♥ 6
♦ K J 9 7 4
♣ J 10

♠ A K Q
♥ A K 9 8
♦ A 10 8 6 3
♣ 5

Board 11
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 9 8 6 4
♥ A J 2
♦ 8
♣ 6 5 4

♠ A 2
♥ Q 9 8 3
♦ 7 6 5 3
♣ 10 9 7

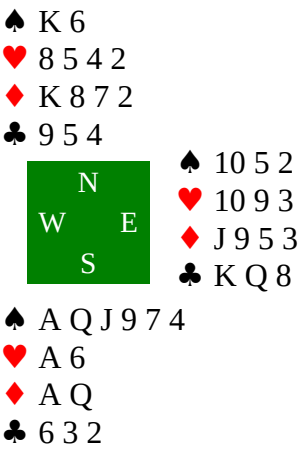
♠ 7
♥ 10 7 5 4
♦ A 9 4 2
♣ K Q J 3

♠ J 10 5 3
♥ K 6
♦ K Q J 10
♣ A 8 2

Board 12
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K 8 6 4 2 ♥ — ♦ J 10 7 3 ♣ Q J 10 2	
♠ Q J 10 9 ♥ Q J 8 ♦ 6 5 2 ♣ 8 4 3		♠ — ♥ A K 9 6 5 4 2 ♦ A Q 4 ♣ K 7 5
	♠ A 7 5 3 ♥ 10 7 3 ♦ K 9 8 ♣ A 9 6	

Board 13
North Deals
Both Vul



Board 14
East Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 10 7 3
♥ J 3
♦ 8 6 2
♣ J 9 5

♠ K 6 5 4 2
♥ A K 8 7 4
♦ A
♣ K 3

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6
♦ K Q J 10 3
♣ A 8 7 4 2

♠ A 9 8
♥ Q 5 2
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ Q 10 6

Board 15
South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 7 4 2
♥ Q J 10 7
♦ 5
♣ A 8 6 4 2

♠ 6 5
♥ 5 4 3 2
♦ Q 2
♣ K Q 9 7 3

♠ J 10 9 8 3
♥ 6
♦ K J 9 7 4
♣ J 10

♠ A K Q
♥ A K 9 8
♦ A 10 8 6 3
♣ 5

Board 16
West Deals
E-W Vul

♠ K Q 9 8 6 4
♥ A J 2
♦ 8
♣ 6 5 4

♠ A 2
♥ Q 9 8 3
♦ 7 6 5 3
♣ 10 9 7

♠ 7
♥ 10 7 5 4
♦ A 9 4 2
♣ K Q J 3

♠ J 10 5 3
♥ K 6
♦ K Q J 10
♣ A 8 2

Board 17
North Deals
None Vul

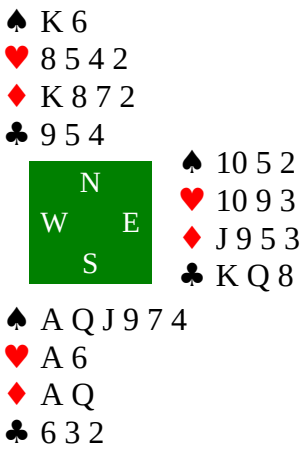
♠ K 8 6 4 2
♥ —
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ Q J 10 2

♠ Q J 10 9
♥ Q J 8
♦ 6 5 2
♣ 8 4 3

♠ —
♥ A K 9 6 5 4 2
♦ A Q 4
♣ K 7 5

♠ A 7 5 3
♥ 10 7 3
♦ K 9 8
♣ A 9 6

Board 18
East Deals
N-S Vul



Board 19
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q J 10 7 3
♥ J 3
♦ 8 6 2
♣ J 9 5

♠ K 6 5 4 2
♥ A K 8 7 4
♦ A
♣ K 3

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6
♦ K Q J 10 3
♣ A 8 7 4 2

♠ A 9 8
♥ Q 5 2
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ Q 10 6

Board 20
West Deals
Both Vul

♠ 7 4 2
♥ Q J 10 7
♦ 5
♣ A 8 6 4 2

♠ 6 5
♥ 5 4 3 2
♦ Q 2
♣ K Q 9 7 3

♠ J 10 9 8 3
♥ 6
♦ K J 9 7 4
♣ J 10

♠ A K Q
♥ A K 9 8
♦ A 10 8 6 3
♣ 5

Board 21
North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K Q 9 8 6 4
♥ A J 2
♦ 8
♣ 6 5 4

♠ A 2
♥ Q 9 8 3
♦ 7 6 5 3
♣ 10 9 7

♠ 7
♥ 10 7 5 4
♦ A 9 4 2
♣ K Q J 3

♠ J 10 5 3
♥ K 6
♦ K Q J 10
♣ A 8 2

Board 22
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ K 8 6 4 2
♥ —
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ Q J 10 2

♠ Q J 10 9
♥ Q J 8
♦ 6 5 2
♣ 8 4 3

♠ —
♥ A K 9 6 5 4 2
♦ A Q 4
♣ K 7 5

♠ A 7 5 3
♥ 10 7 3
♦ K 9 8
♣ A 9 6

Board 23
South Deals
Both Vul

♠ K 6
♥ 8 5 4 2
♦ K 8 7 2
♣ 9 5 4

♠ 8 3
♥ K Q J 7
♦ 10 6 4
♣ A J 10 7

♠ 10 5 2
♥ 10 9 3
♦ J 9 5 3
♣ K Q 8

♠ A Q J 9 7 4
♥ A 6
♦ A Q
♣ 6 3 2

Board 24
West Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 10 7 3
♥ J 3
♦ 8 6 2
♣ J 9 5

♠ K 6 5 4 2
♥ A K 8 7 4
♦ A
♣ K 3

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6
♦ K Q J 10 3
♣ A 8 7 4 2

♠ A 9 8
♥ Q 5 2
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ Q 10 6

Board 25
North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 7 4 2
♥ Q J 10 7
♦ 5
♣ A 8 6 4 2

♠ 6 5
♥ 5 4 3 2
♦ Q 2
♣ K Q 9 7 3

♠ J 10 9 8 3
♥ 6
♦ K J 9 7 4
♣ J 10

♠ A K Q
♥ A K 9 8
♦ A 10 8 6 3
♣ 5

Board 26
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ K Q 9 8 6 4
♥ A J 2
♦ 8
♣ 6 5 4

♠ A 2
♥ Q 9 8 3
♦ 7 6 5 3
♣ 10 9 7

♠ 7
♥ 10 7 5 4
♦ A 9 4 2
♣ K Q J 3

♠ J 10 5 3
♥ K 6
♦ K Q J 10
♣ A 8 2

Board 27
South Deals
None Vul

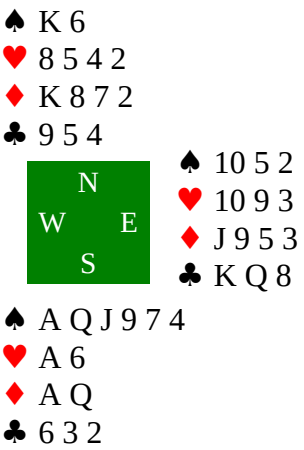
♠ K 8 6 4 2
♥ —
♦ J 10 7 3
♣ Q J 10 2

♠ Q J 10 9
♥ Q J 8
♦ 6 5 2
♣ 8 4 3

♠ —
♥ A K 9 6 5 4 2
♦ A Q 4
♣ K 7 5

♠ A 7 5 3
♥ 10 7 3
♦ K 9 8
♣ A 9 6

Board 28
West Deals
N-S Vul



Board 29
North Deals
Both Vul

♠ Q J 10 7 3
♥ J 3
♦ 8 6 2
♣ J 9 5

♠ K 6 5 4 2
♥ A K 8 7 4
♦ A
♣ K 3

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6
♦ K Q J 10 3
♣ A 8 7 4 2

♠ A 9 8
♥ Q 5 2
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ Q 10 6

Board 30
East Deals
None Vul

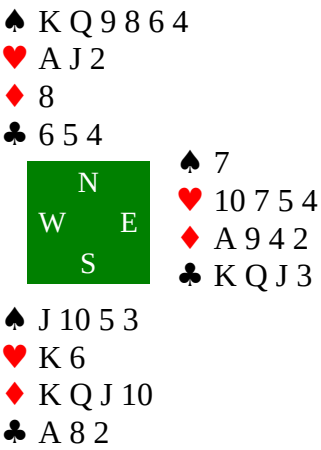
♠ 7 4 2
♥ Q J 10 7
♦ 5
♣ A 8 6 4 2

♠ 6 5
♥ 5 4 3 2
♦ Q 2
♣ K Q 9 7 3

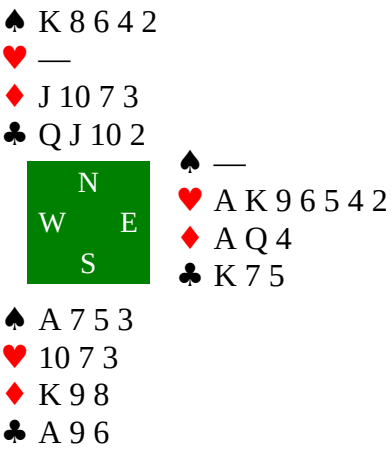
♠ J 10 9 8 3
♥ 6
♦ K J 9 7 4
♣ J 10

♠ A K Q
♥ A K 9 8
♦ A 10 8 6 3
♣ 5

Board 31
South Deals
N-S Vul



Board 32
West Deals
E-W Vul



Board 33
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 6
♥ 8 5 4 2
♦ K 8 7 2
♣ 9 5 4

♠ 8 3
♥ K Q J 7
♦ 10 6 4
♣ A J 10 7

♠ 10 5 2
♥ 10 9 3
♦ J 9 5 3
♣ K Q 8

♠ A Q J 9 7 4
♥ A 6
♦ A Q
♣ 6 3 2

Board 34
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ Q J 10 7 3
♥ J 3
♦ 8 6 2
♣ J 9 5

♠ K 6 5 4 2
♥ A K 8 7 4
♦ A
♣ K 3

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6
♦ K Q J 10 3
♣ A 8 7 4 2

♠ A 9 8
♥ Q 5 2
♦ 9 7 5 4
♣ Q 10 6

Board 35
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 7 4 2
♥ Q J 10 7
♦ 5
♣ A 8 6 4 2

♠ 6 5
♥ 5 4 3 2
♦ Q 2
♣ K Q 9 7 3

♠ J 10 9 8 3
♥ 6
♦ K J 9 7 4
♣ J 10

♠ A K Q
♥ A K 9 8
♦ A 10 8 6 3
♣ 5